

TIME INTELLIGENCE MASTERCLASS

WEEK 1

TIME AWARENESS

By

TOBAMS GROUP ACADEMY

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1. Understanding Your Personal Relationship with Time

- Understanding Your Relationship with Time
- Five Common Relationships with Time
- Your Time Beliefs Influence Your Behaviour
- The Difference Between Having Time and Using Time Intentionally
- Personal Reflection
- Practical Exersscise - Your Time Mindset Check

Central Question:

How do I currently think about, value and use my time?

1. Understanding Your Relationship with Time

Everyone has the same 24 hours in a day, but we do not all have the same responsibilities, resources, energy levels or freedom to decide how those hours are spent.

Your relationship with time describes how you think about time, how you respond to competing demands and the decisions you make about where your time goes.

Some people see time as something they must constantly chase. Others treat it as something to fill with activities. Some feel guilty when resting, while others struggle to begin important tasks despite having available time.

These patterns influence how effectively we use time across our careers, businesses, education, relationships, families and personal lives.

Time Intelligence begins with understanding your relationship with time before attempting to change how you manage it.

2. Five Common Relationships with Time

Relationship	Typical Behaviour
The Time Chaser	Constantly rushing and feeling there is never enough time.
The Busy Achiever	Staying occupied but struggling to identify meaningful progress.
The Time Avoider	Postponing important activities despite recognising their importance.
The Overcommitted Individual	Accepting more responsibilities than available capacity can realistically support.
The Intentional Time User	Making deliberate decisions about priorities, commitments and how time is allocated.

These are reflection categories, not fixed personality types. You may recognise yourself in more than one category depending on your circumstances.

3. Your Time Beliefs Influence Your Behaviour

The way you think about time often determines how you use it.

Consider these common beliefs:

- **“I never have enough time.”** This may encourage frustration rather than examining existing commitments.
- **“Being busy means I am productive.”** This can lead to activity without meaningful progress.
- **“I work better under pressure.”** This may reinforce procrastination and unnecessary urgency.
- **“I must always be available.”** This can make it difficult to protect personal priorities.
- **“Resting means I am wasting time.”** This may undermine recovery and long-term effectiveness.

Developing Time Intelligence involves questioning these beliefs and replacing unhelpful assumptions with more intentional thinking.

For example, instead of automatically saying, *“I don't have time,”* consider asking:

“Is this a priority, a capacity limitation or something I need to approach differently?”

This question encourages more thoughtful decisions without ignoring genuine constraints.

4. The Difference Between Having Time and Using Time Intentionally

Having available time does not automatically mean using it effectively.

Imagine two individuals who each have two hours available.

Person A spends the time responding to notifications, moving between unrelated activities and postponing an important task.

Person B identifies one meaningful priority, protects time for it and completes an important part of the activity.

Both individuals had the same amount of available time, but they made different decisions about how to use it.

The difference is not simply time management. It is awareness, intention and execution.

However, effective time use does not mean every available hour must produce a measurable output. Rest, relationships, recreation and personal wellbeing can also represent valuable uses of time.

The objective is not to fill every hour. It is to use your time in ways that reflect what genuinely matters.

5. PERSONAL REFLECTION

Take approximately five minutes to consider the following questions.

Reflection Question 1

Which of the five relationships with time best describes you today, and why?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 2

What do you frequently tell yourself about time?

For example: *"I am always busy," "I never finish anything,"* or *"There is never enough time for myself."*

.....

.....

Reflection Question 3

Does the way you currently use your time reflect what you consider most important in your life?

What might explain any differences?

.....

.....

6. PRACTICAL EXERCISE - YOUR TIME MINDSET CHECK

Duration: 5–10 minutes
Complete the following statements as honestly as possible.

Statement	Your Response
My biggest frustration with time is...	
I feel most in control of my time when...	
I feel least in control of my time when...	
One activity I wish I had more time for is...	
One commitment I need to reconsider is...	
One belief about time I would like to change is...	

Your Personal Commitment

Based on your reflections, complete this sentence:

"Over the next six weeks, I want to change my relationship with time by..."

.....

.....

7. KEY TAKEAWAYS

1. Your relationship with time is shaped by your beliefs, habits, responsibilities and everyday decisions.
2. Being constantly busy does not necessarily mean using time effectively.
3. Understanding your current time behaviours is the starting point for meaningful improvement.
4. Effective time use involves making intentional choices, not simply doing more.
5. Your goal is to develop a healthier, more deliberate and sustainable relationship with time.

FINAL THOUGHT

"You cannot create more time, but you can become more intelligent about how you use the time available to you."

Next Subtopic: Exploring the 168-Hour Week and the Reality of Available Time.

2: Exploring the 168-Hour Week and the Reality of Available Time

- Understanding the 168-Hour Reality
- Where Do Your 168 Hours Go?
- The Difference Between Total Time and Available Time
- Why Your Calendar May Not Reflect Your Reality
- Three Questions That Reveal Your Time Reality
- Personal Reflection
- Practical Exercise - Your 168-Hour Time Audit

Central Question:

How much time do I really have, and where does it go?

1. Understanding the 168-Hour Reality

Every week contains **168 hours**.

Regardless of our ambitions, responsibilities or circumstances, the number of hours in a week remains the same.

However, the amount of time available for personal choice differs considerably between individuals. Employment, family responsibilities, commuting, caring duties, health needs and other commitments influence how much time we can realistically control.

Many people believe they have very little time because they focus on how busy each day feels rather than examining how their entire week is structured.

The 168-hour perspective helps us see the bigger picture.

Time Intelligence begins with understanding how your available hours are currently distributed before deciding what needs to change.

2. Where Do Your 168 Hours Go?

Consider the following illustrative weekly allocation.

Activity	Hours Per Week
Sleep (8 hours daily)	56
Work or business	40
Commuting	7
Meals and personal care	14
Family and household responsibilities	21
Leisure, social activities and entertainment	14
Personal development and other activities	16
TOTAL	**168**

This example is not a recommended schedule. It simply demonstrates how quickly weekly hours become allocated.

Your circumstances may be very different. For example, someone caring for young children or elderly relatives may have significantly less discretionary time than someone without those responsibilities.

The purpose is not to compare yourself with others but to understand your own reality.

3. The Difference Between Total Time and Available Time

Although everyone has 168 hours each week, not all those hours are available for discretionary activities.

It is useful to distinguish three categories:

1. Essential Time

Time required for activities such as sleeping, eating, personal care and necessary health-related routines.

2. Committed Time

Time allocated to responsibilities such as employment, education, caregiving, commuting and household obligations.

3. Discretionary Time

Time over which you have greater flexibility, such as certain leisure activities, personal projects, learning and other chosen commitments.

Importantly, discretionary time is not automatically wasted time. Recreation, relationships and rest may be among its most valuable uses.

Understanding these categories helps prevent unrealistic expectations about how much you can accomplish.

4. Why Your Calendar May Not Reflect Your Reality

Many individuals plan their weeks based on ideal circumstances rather than what actually happens.

For example, you may allocate two hours to an important personal project but overlook:

- Unexpected family responsibilities.
- Interruptions and unplanned requests.
- Travel or preparation time.
- Mental and physical fatigue.
- Activities that take longer than expected.

As a result, your schedule may appear achievable on paper but become difficult to maintain.

A realistic weekly plan must account for both predictable responsibilities and some flexibility for unexpected demands.

A well-designed week is not one in which every hour is occupied. It is one in which important commitments can be managed sustainably.

5. Three Questions That Reveal Your Time Reality

Before attempting to become more productive, consider three important questions.

Where is my time going?

Identify how your hours are currently allocated rather than relying on assumptions.

How much of my time can I realistically influence?

Recognise which commitments are essential, which are negotiable and which may need to be reconsidered.

Does my current time allocation reflect my priorities?

Consider whether important areas of your life are receiving appropriate attention.

These questions help shift your thinking from *"I need more time"* towards *"I need to understand how my time is currently being used."*

6. PERSONAL REFLECTION

Take approximately five minutes to consider the following questions.

Reflection Question 1

Before reading this learning note, had you considered your time in terms of 168 hours per week?

What does this perspective reveal about your current situation?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 2

Which activities or responsibilities consume the greatest proportion of your weekly time?

Are you comfortable with that allocation?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 3

What important area of your life currently receives less time than you would like? What prevents you from allocating more time to it?

.....

.....

7. PRACTICAL EXERCISE - YOUR 168-HOUR TIME AUDIT

Duration: 10–15 minutes

Estimate how you currently spend your time during a typical week.

Use your actual circumstances rather than an ideal schedule.

Activity	Your Weekly Hours
Sleep and rest	
Work, business or education	
Commuting and travel	
Meals and personal care	
Family and caring responsibilities	
Household responsibilities	
Leisure, entertainment and social activities	
Personal development and meaningful goals	
Other activities	
TOTAL	**168**

Step 1 - Calculate Your Total

Add the hours allocated to each category.

If the total is significantly above or below 168, revisit your estimates. Ensure activities are not counted twice.

Step 2 - Identify Your Largest Time Commitments

Highlight the three categories consuming the greatest amount of time.

Step 3 - Examine Your Available Time

Identify which activities are essential, which are committed responsibilities and which allow greater flexibility.

Step 4 - Identify One Opportunity for Improvement

Choose one realistic adjustment that could help you use your time more intentionally.

This might involve reducing unnecessary screen time, reviewing a recurring commitment, protecting time for an important goal or allowing more realistic time for rest.

Your Personal Commitment

Complete the following statement:

“After reviewing my 168-hour week, one change I want to make is...”

.....

.....

8. KEY TAKEAWAYS

1. Every week contains 168 hours, but individuals have different levels of control over those hours.
2. Understanding your weekly time allocation provides a clearer picture than simply feeling busy.
3. Essential, committed and discretionary time should be considered separately.
4. Effective planning requires realistic allowances for responsibilities, interruptions and recovery.
5. Small, deliberate adjustments to weekly time allocation can support meaningful progress.

FINAL THOUGHT

“Before you can change how you use your time, you must understand where it is already going.”

Next Subtopic: Distinguishing Between Being Busy, Productive and Effective.

3: Distinguishing Between Being Busy, Productive and Effective

- Understanding the Difference
- Being Busy: The Activity Trap
- Being Productive: Getting Things Done
- Being Effective: Achieving Meaningful Outcomes
- Moving from Busyness to Effectiveness
- Personal Reflection
- Practical Exercise - The Busy, Productive Or Effective Test

Central Question:

Am I simply doing more, or am I accomplishing what truly matters?

1. Understanding the Difference

One of the biggest misconceptions about time management is the belief that being constantly occupied means we are making meaningful progress.

Many individuals spend their days responding to messages, attending meetings, completing routine activities and managing competing responsibilities. By the end of the day, they feel exhausted but struggle to identify what they have actually accomplished.

This happens because **being busy, being productive and being effective are not the same thing.**

Understanding these differences is essential to developing Time Intelligence.

Dimension	Meaning	Key Question
Busy	Spending time engaged in activities, regardless of their importance or outcomes.	What am I doing?
Productive	Completing tasks and producing useful outputs with available resources.	What am I accomplishing?
Effective	Achieving meaningful outcomes that contribute to important priorities and goals.	Am I achieving what matters?

A person can be busy without being productive. Similarly, someone can be productive without necessarily being effective.

Time Intelligence is not about maximising activity. It is about ensuring that the activities receiving your time contribute to meaningful outcomes.

2. Being Busy: The Activity Trap

Busyness often creates the impression that something important is happening.

Consider someone who spends an entire day answering emails, attending unnecessary meetings and responding to other people's requests.

They may have worked continuously for eight hours but made little progress on their most important responsibilities.

Busyness becomes problematic when activity replaces deliberate decision-making.

Common signs of the activity trap include:

- Constantly moving between activities without clear priorities.

- Feeling uncomfortable when there is nothing urgent to do.
- Responding to every request immediately.
- Measuring success by hours worked rather than results achieved.
- Ending the day exhausted without meaningful progress.

Being busy is sometimes unavoidable, particularly during demanding periods. The challenge is recognising when busyness has become a permanent way of operating.

3. Being Productive: Getting Things Done

Productivity focuses on converting time and effort into useful outputs.

A productive individual can organise activities, complete tasks and make measurable progress.

For example, a student who completes an assignment, a business owner who develops a proposal or a parent who successfully organises important family arrangements has produced a useful outcome.

However, productivity alone does not guarantee effectiveness.

Imagine completing ten tasks in a day while postponing the one activity that would make the greatest difference to an important goal.

You have been productive, but your time may not have been used as effectively as possible.

Productivity asks whether you are getting things done. Effectiveness asks whether you are getting the right things done.

4. Being Effective: Achieving Meaningful Outcomes

Effectiveness involves directing time, attention and effort towards activities that genuinely matter.

It requires understanding priorities, making deliberate choices and evaluating results rather than simply counting completed tasks.

Consider three examples:

Professional Life

A manager attends six meetings in one day but makes no progress on an important decision. Another manager attends two essential meetings and resolves a major operational problem.

Personal Development

One individual spends hours watching educational videos without applying anything. Another studies one relevant concept and immediately uses it to improve a skill.

Family and Relationships

A parent spends an entire evening physically present with family but remains distracted by their phone. Another deliberately protects uninterrupted time for meaningful interaction.

In each example, the quality and relevance of how time is used matter more than the quantity of activities completed.

Effectiveness does not mean every hour must produce an achievement. Rest, recreation and meaningful relationships can also be effective uses of time when they support genuine personal priorities.

5. Moving from Busyness to Effectiveness

Developing Time Intelligence requires a shift in how we evaluate our days.

Instead of asking, *"How much did I do today?"* consider asking:

"What meaningful progress did I make today?"

Three practical approaches can support this shift.

1. Identify Your Most Important Outcome

Before beginning your day, identify one meaningful result you want to achieve.

2. Distinguish Activity from Progress

Regularly consider whether your activities are moving you towards your priorities or simply keeping you occupied.

3. Review Results, Not Just Completed Tasks

At the end of the day, evaluate what changed, improved or progressed because of how you used your time.

This approach encourages intentionality without creating unnecessary pressure to achieve something every moment.

6. PERSONAL REFLECTION

Take approximately five minutes to reflect on the following questions.

Reflection Question 1

Think about your last three days. Were you mostly busy, productive or effective?

What makes you say so?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 2

Which activities regularly keep you busy without contributing significantly to your priorities?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 3

What important goal or responsibility have you been postponing while completing less important activities?

.....

.....

7. PRACTICAL EXERCISE - THE BUSY, PRODUCTIVE OR EFFECTIVE TEST

Duration: 10–15 minutes

Think about five activities you completed yesterday or during a recent typical day.

Record them in the table below.

Activity	Time Spent	Busy, Productive or Effective?	Meaningful Result
Activity 1			
Activity 2			
Activity 3			
Activity 4			
Activity 5			

Step 1 - Classify Your Activities

Use the following guide:

- **Busy:** The activity occupied your time but produced limited meaningful progress.
- **Productive:** The activity produced a useful output or completed a necessary task.
- **Effective:** The activity contributed directly to an important priority or meaningful outcome.

Some activities may be both productive and effective. For this exercise, select the description that best represents their overall value.

Step 2 - Identify Your Most Valuable Activity

Which activity produced the most meaningful result?

Why was it important?

.....

Step 3 - Identify One Activity to Reconsider

Which activity consumed time without delivering sufficient value?

Could it be reduced, simplified, delegated or approached differently?

.....

Step 4 - Make One Practical Change

Identify one action you will take tomorrow to shift from unnecessary busyness towards greater effectiveness.

My action:

.....

.....

8. KEY TAKEAWAYS

1. Being busy means engaging in activities; it does not necessarily mean achieving meaningful results.
2. Productivity involves completing tasks and producing useful outputs.
3. Effectiveness focuses on achieving outcomes that genuinely matter.
4. Completing more tasks does not automatically mean using time more intelligently.
5. Time Intelligence involves evaluating how activities contribute to your priorities, responsibilities and goals.

FINAL THOUGHT

“Being busy fills your time. Being productive produces results. Being effective ensures those results matter.”

The goal is not to become busier. It is to become more intentional about what deserves your time and attention.

Next Subtopic: Identifying Time Leaks, Hidden Time Consumers and Recurring Inefficiencies.

4: Identifying Time Leaks, Hidden Time Consumers and Recurring Inefficiencies

- Understanding Time Leaks
- Common Sources of Time Leaks
- Understanding Hidden Time Consumers
- The Cumulative Cost of Small Time Leaks
- Reducing Time Leaks Without Creating More Pressure
- Personal Reflection
- Practical Exercise - Your Personal Time Leak Audit

Central Question:

Where am I losing valuable time without realising it?

1. Understanding Time Leaks

Time is not always lost through major activities or obvious distractions. Sometimes, it disappears through small, repeated behaviours that gradually consume significant portions of our days.

A **time leak** occurs when time is repeatedly consumed by activities, interruptions or inefficient processes that provide limited value relative to the time invested.

For example, spending 15 minutes unnecessarily checking social media four times a day amounts to one hour daily. Over seven days, that becomes seven hours.

However, not every unplanned activity represents wasted time. Rest, meaningful conversations and unexpected family responsibilities may be valuable or necessary.

The purpose of identifying time leaks is not to eliminate every moment of flexibility. It is to recognise where time is being consumed unnecessarily and where improvements are possible.

Time Intelligence requires understanding not only where your time goes, but also whether the time invested is justified by the value it creates.

2. Common Sources of Time Leaks

Time leaks appear in different forms depending on our responsibilities, lifestyles and working environments.

Time Leak	Typical Example	Potential Impact
Digital Distractions	Repeatedly checking phones, notifications or social media.	Fragmented attention and lost time.
Unnecessary Activities	Attending meetings or completing activities with little purpose.	Reduced time for meaningful priorities.
Poor Organisation	Searching repeatedly for documents, information or belongings.	Avoidable delays and frustration.
Indecision	Spending excessive time deciding what to do next.	Delayed action and reduced progress.
Task Switching	Frequently moving between unrelated activities.	Additional time needed to regain concentration.
Overcommitment	Accepting unnecessary responsibilities or requests.	Reduced capacity for important commitments.

Perfectionism	Spending excessive time improving work beyond what is required.	Delayed completion and inefficient effort.

These activities may appear insignificant individually, but their cumulative impact can be substantial.

3. Understanding Hidden Time Consumers

Some activities consume more time than we realise because they are embedded in our normal routines.

For example:

The Five-Minute Interruption

A person receives several messages throughout the day and responds immediately. Although each interruption appears brief, the repeated disruption may make it difficult to complete activities requiring sustained concentration.

The Unplanned Commitment

Someone agrees to help with an activity expected to take 30 minutes. Preparation, travel and additional requests eventually turn it into a two-hour commitment.

The Repeated Decision

An individual begins each day without identifying priorities and repeatedly spends time deciding which task to undertake next.

The problem is not always the activity itself. It may be the absence of boundaries, preparation or an effective process.

4. The Cumulative Cost of Small Time Leaks

Small amounts of time become significant when repeated consistently.

Consider the following illustrative example:

Daily Time Leak	Weekly Impact	Annual Impact*
10 minutes	1 hour 10 minutes	Approximately 61 hours
20 minutes	2 hours 20 minutes	Approximately 122 hours
30 minutes	3 hours 30 minutes	Approximately 183 hours
60 minutes	7 hours	Approximately 365 hours

Annual figures assume the activity occurs every day for 365 days.

This does not mean all these hours can or should be recovered. Some interruptions are unavoidable, while others provide legitimate personal or social value.

The important question is whether a repeated activity deserves the amount of time it receives.

Small changes to recurring behaviours can create meaningful opportunities for better time allocation.

5. Reducing Time Leaks Without Creating More Pressure

Once a time leak has been identified, the next step is to decide how it should be managed.

Five practical approaches can help:

1. Eliminate

Stop activities that provide little value and are not necessary.

2. Reduce

Limit the frequency or duration of activities that consume excessive time.

3. Simplify

Find a more straightforward way to complete recurring responsibilities.

4. Organise

Improve preparation, routines and access to frequently needed information.

5. Protect

Create boundaries around important activities to minimise avoidable interruptions.

The objective is not to control every minute. It is to reduce unnecessary friction and create more space for meaningful priorities.

6. PERSONAL REFLECTION

Take approximately five minutes to consider the following questions.

Reflection Question 1

Which three activities or habits consume more of your time than you would like?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 2

What interruptions occur most frequently during your day?

How do they affect your ability to complete important activities?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 3

Is there an activity you continue doing simply because it has become a habit, rather than because it remains necessary or valuable?

.....

.....

7. PRACTICAL EXERCISE - YOUR PERSONAL TIME LEAK AUDIT

Duration: 10–15 minutes

Think about a typical day and identify five activities, interruptions or habits that may be consuming more time than necessary.

Complete the following table.

Activity or Time Leak	Estimated Daily Time	Why Does It Happen?	Action Required
1.			
2.			
3.			
4.			
5.			

Step 1 - Identify Your Largest Time Leak

Which activity consumes the most unnecessary time?

.....

Step 2 - Understand the Cause

Is the activity driven by habit, distraction, poor planning, external demands or something else?

.....

Step 3 - Choose One Improvement

Select one action you can realistically implement over the next seven days.

For example:

- Check non-urgent messages at designated times.
- Reduce unnecessary scrolling.
- Prepare tomorrow's priorities the evening before.
- Organise frequently used materials.
- Establish boundaries around avoidable interruptions.

Step 4 - Measure the Difference

At the end of seven days, reflect on whether the change reduced unnecessary time consumption.

My seven-day commitment:

"I will reduce or improve _____ by _____."

My expected benefit:

.....

8. KEY TAKEAWAYS

1. Time leaks often result from small, repeated behaviours rather than major activities.
2. Hidden time consumers may include distractions, unnecessary commitments, indecision and inefficient routines.
3. The cumulative impact of recurring inefficiencies can be significant.
4. Not every unplanned activity is wasted time; value and personal circumstances must be considered.
5. Reducing time leaks involves eliminating, reducing, simplifying, organising or protecting activities where appropriate.

FINAL THOUGHT

"Time is not always lost in hours. Sometimes, it disappears in minutes we never question."

Developing Time Intelligence means becoming more aware of these patterns and making deliberate adjustments that support what matters most.

Next Subtopic: Examining How Daily Habits and Decisions Influence Time Utilisation.

5: Examining How Daily Habits and Decisions Influence Time Utilisation

- Understanding the Connection Between Habits, Decisions and Time
- How Habits Shape Our Daily Time
- Understanding the Habit Loop
- The Hidden Impact of Everyday Decisions
- Building Better Habits for Time Intelligence
- Personal Reflection
- Practical Exercise - The Seven-Day Habit Reset

Central Question:

Are my daily habits and decisions helping me use my time effectively?

1. Understanding the Connection Between Habits, Decisions and Time

How we use our time is influenced not only by our schedules and responsibilities but also by the small decisions and repeated behaviours that shape our everyday lives.

A **habit** is a behaviour that becomes increasingly automatic through repetition. A **decision** is a choice we make about what to do, when to do it and how much time to invest.

For example, checking your phone immediately after waking up may become a habit. Choosing to spend the first 20 minutes of your morning planning your priorities is a deliberate decision.

Both influence how your day unfolds.

Over time, repeated habits and decisions can either support meaningful progress or create unnecessary inefficiencies.

Time Intelligence involves recognising that the quality of our daily decisions often determines the quality of our time utilisation.

2. How Habits Shape Our Daily Time

Many daily activities happen with little conscious thought. This can be helpful when habits support our priorities, but problematic when they repeatedly consume time without sufficient value.

Consider the following examples.

Daily Habit	**Potential Impact on Time**	**More Intentional Alternative**
Checking your phone immediately after waking	May delay important morning activities.	Begin with a short morning routine.
Starting the day without clear priorities	May encourage reactive decision-making.	Identify three important activities.
Responding immediately to every notification	May interrupt concentration.	Check non-urgent messages at planned intervals.
Leaving important tasks until the last minute	May create unnecessary pressure.	Begin with one manageable action.
Regularly working without adequate breaks	May contribute to fatigue and reduced concentration.	Include appropriate rest and recovery.

Reviewing the day before finishing	Can improve awareness and preparation.	Maintain a brief daily reflection routine.

The objective is not to create a rigid lifestyle. It is to develop habits that make important activities easier to accomplish.

3. Understanding the Habit Loop

A simple way to understand habits is through three interconnected elements:

CUE → BEHAVIOUR → REWARD

Cue: Something triggers the behaviour.

Behaviour: The action you take.

Reward: The immediate benefit or satisfaction that reinforces the behaviour.

Example: Repeatedly Checking Your Phone

- **Cue:** You feel bored or encounter a difficult task.
- **Behaviour:** You open a social media application.
- **Reward:** You experience temporary entertainment or relief.

When this pattern is repeated, checking your phone may become an automatic response to boredom or discomfort.

To change the habit, you can identify the trigger and introduce a more useful response.

For example, when you encounter a difficult task, you might take a short planned break or divide the task into smaller steps rather than automatically reaching for your phone.

Understanding the pattern helps you make deliberate adjustments.

4. The Hidden Impact of Everyday Decisions

Every day involves numerous decisions about how we allocate time.

Some decisions are significant, while others appear almost inconsequential.

For example:

- Do I begin my important task now or postpone it?
- Do I accept another commitment despite an already demanding schedule?
- Do I continue an activity that is no longer useful?
- Do I protect time for rest, learning or relationships?

- Do I respond immediately to a request or consider its priority first?

Each decision influences what receives your time and attention.

One useful principle is to **reduce unnecessary decisions while improving the quality of important ones**.

For instance, preparing your priorities in advance may reduce the time spent deciding what to do each morning.

Similarly, establishing a consistent routine for recurring activities can make it easier to follow through without repeatedly reconsidering the same choices.

5. Building Better Habits for Time Intelligence

Improving time utilisation does not require changing every habit simultaneously.

Small, consistent adjustments are often more practical and sustainable.

Consider five approaches.

1. Start Small

Choose one manageable behaviour rather than attempting a complete lifestyle transformation.

2. Connect the Habit to an Existing Routine

For example, after your morning breakfast, spend five minutes reviewing your priorities.

3. Make the Desired Behaviour Easier

Prepare the materials, environment or information needed to complete an important activity.

4. Reduce Unnecessary Triggers

Limit distractions that repeatedly encourage unhelpful behaviours.

5. Review and Adjust

Reflect on whether the new habit is helping and adapt it to your circumstances.

Remember that consistency does not mean perfection. Unexpected responsibilities, illness and changes in circumstances may require flexibility.

The purpose of developing better habits is to make intentional time use easier, not to create additional pressure.

6. PERSONAL REFLECTION

Take approximately five minutes to consider the following questions.

Reflection Question 1

What three daily habits have the greatest influence on how you use your time?

Are their effects mostly positive or negative?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 2

Think about a recent decision that caused you to spend time on something less important.

What influenced that decision?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 3

If you could change just one daily habit to improve your use of time, what would it be, and why?

.....

.....

7. PRACTICAL EXERCISE - THE SEVEN-DAY HABIT RESET

Duration: 10–15 minutes for planning, followed by a seven-day experiment

This exercise helps you identify one unhelpful habit and replace it with a more intentional behaviour.

Step 1 - Identify Your Current Habits

Complete the table below.

Current Habit	When Does It Happen?	Impact on My Time	Keep, Improve or Replace?
Habit 1			
Habit 2			
Habit 3			

Step 2 - Choose One Habit to Improve

Select one habit that is realistic to change over the next seven days.

The habit I want to improve is:

.....

Step 3 - Identify the Trigger

What usually causes this habit?

For example, boredom, tiredness, stress, notifications or a particular time of day.

.....

Step 4 - Create a Replacement Behaviour

Complete the following statement:

"When _____ happens, instead of _____, I will _____."

Example:

"When I begin my working day, instead of immediately checking non-urgent messages, I will spend five minutes identifying my most important priority."

Step 5 - Monitor Your Progress

Use the following simple tracker.

Day	Did I Practise My New Habit?	What Did I Notice?
Day 1	Yes / No	
Day 2	Yes / No	
Day 3	Yes / No	
Day 4	Yes / No	
Day 5	Yes / No	
Day 6	Yes / No	
Day 7	Yes / No	

Step 6 - Reflect on the Results

At the end of seven days, answer:

What improved?

.....

What challenges did I experience?

.....

What adjustment will help me maintain this habit?

.....

8. KEY TAKEAWAYS

1. Daily habits and decisions significantly influence how we allocate and use time.
2. Repeated behaviours can either support meaningful priorities or contribute to unnecessary inefficiencies.
3. Understanding the triggers behind habits makes it easier to change them.
4. Small, deliberate decisions can improve time utilisation without requiring major lifestyle changes.
5. Sustainable Time Intelligence involves developing habits that support priorities, wellbeing and personal effectiveness.

FINAL THOUGHT

“Your relationship with time is shaped not only by the hours you have, but by the habits and decisions you repeat every day.”

Meaningful improvement often begins with one small decision, practised consistently.

Next Subtopic: Understanding the Impact of Personal Roles, Responsibilities and Commitments.

6: Understanding the Impact of Personal Roles, Responsibilities and Commitments

- Understanding Your Multiple Roles
- Understanding the Difference Between Roles, Responsibilities and Commitments
- How Competing Roles Create Time Pressure
- Recognising the Signs of Overcommitment
- Managing Roles and Commitments More Intentionally
- Personal Reflection
- Practical Exercise - Your Personal Role And Commitment Map

Central Question:

How do the different roles I play in life influence the way I use my time?

1. Understanding Your Multiple Roles

Every individual occupies different roles that require time, attention and energy.

You may be an employee, entrepreneur, student, parent, spouse, caregiver, community leader or someone pursuing personal ambitions. Each role brings expectations, responsibilities and commitments.

These roles do not exist independently. They compete for the same limited hours and personal resources.

For example, a professional who is also a parent and student may need to balance employment, family responsibilities, academic deadlines and personal wellbeing.

The challenge is not necessarily having too many roles. It is understanding what each role requires and whether your available time and capacity can realistically support those demands.

Time Intelligence involves recognising your responsibilities, understanding their demands and making deliberate choices about how your time is distributed.

2. Understanding the Difference Between Roles, Responsibilities and Commitments

Although these terms are closely related, they represent different aspects of how we use our time.

Dimension	Meaning	Example
Role	A position or function you occupy in your personal or professional life.	Parent, manager, student or entrepreneur.
Responsibility	An obligation or duty associated with a particular role.	Caring for children, managing a team or completing coursework.
Commitment	An agreement or decision to dedicate time and effort to an activity.	Attending weekly meetings, volunteering or completing a project.

Understanding these differences helps you identify where your time demands originate.

Some responsibilities are essential and cannot easily be reduced. Other commitments may be optional, negotiable or temporary.

The objective is to distinguish between what you must do, what you have agreed to do and what you genuinely want to do.

3. How Competing Roles Create Time Pressure

Time pressure often arises when several responsibilities require attention simultaneously.

Consider the following examples.

Example 1: The Working Parent

A parent must complete an important work assignment while managing school activities, household responsibilities and family needs.

Example 2: The Entrepreneur

A business owner is responsible for customers, employees, finances, operations and business development. Each area competes for attention.

Example 3: The Working Student

An individual combines employment with academic studies, personal development and social responsibilities.

In each situation, the individual may experience competing demands even when managing their time carefully.

This is why effective time management must consider **the reality of responsibilities rather than assuming that every hour is freely available.**

4. Recognising the Signs of Overcommitment

Overcommitment occurs when the demands placed on your time and energy consistently exceed what you can realistically manage.

Common signs include:

- Frequently feeling rushed or overwhelmed.
- Struggling to complete important responsibilities.
- Regularly sacrificing rest or personal wellbeing.
- Accepting new commitments without reviewing existing obligations.
- Experiencing conflicts between personal and professional responsibilities.
- Feeling guilty when declining requests or taking time for yourself.

Overcommitment does not always result from poor decisions. It may also arise from financial pressures, caregiving responsibilities, organisational demands or unexpected circumstances.

The important step is recognising when your commitments are becoming unsustainable and identifying where adjustments or support may be possible.

5. Managing Roles and Commitments More Intentionally

Developing Time Intelligence does not require giving equal time to every role.

Different responsibilities require different levels of attention depending on their importance, urgency and your circumstances.

Five practical approaches can help.

1. Identify Your Current Roles

List the major roles you occupy and the responsibilities associated with each.

2. Understand Your Non-Negotiable Responsibilities

Recognise obligations that require consistent attention, such as essential work, caregiving or health needs.

3. Review Your Existing Commitments

Consider whether every recurring activity remains necessary, valuable or appropriate.

4. Establish Realistic Boundaries

Where possible, communicate your availability, negotiate expectations and avoid accepting unnecessary commitments.

5. Review Your Roles Regularly

Your responsibilities will change over time. Your approach to allocating time should evolve accordingly.

The goal is not perfect balance every day. It is a sustainable approach that reflects your responsibilities, priorities and personal circumstances.

6. PERSONAL REFLECTION

Take approximately five minutes to consider the following questions.

Reflection Question 1

What are the five most important roles you currently occupy?

Which requires the greatest amount of your time?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 2

Are there responsibilities or commitments that regularly conflict with one another?

How do you currently manage those situations?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 3

Is there a role or important area of your life that is receiving less attention than you would like?

What could help you address this?

.....

.....

7. PRACTICAL EXERCISE - YOUR PERSONAL ROLE AND COMMITMENT MAP

Duration: 10–15 minutes

This exercise helps you understand how your different roles influence your time allocation.

Step 1 - Identify Your Roles

List up to five significant roles you currently occupy.

My Role	Main Responsibilities	Weekly Time Demand	Current Challenge
Role 1			
Role 2			
Role 3			
Role 4			
Role 5			

Note: Some roles overlap. Avoid adding these estimates together without accounting for shared activities.

Step 2 - Identify Competing Demands

Which two roles create the greatest competition for your time?

Role 1: .....

Role 2: .....

What creates the conflict?

.....

Step 3 - Review Your Commitments

Identify one recurring commitment that could potentially be:

- **Maintained:** It remains essential or valuable.
- **Reduced:** It requires less time or frequency.
- **Renegotiated:** Expectations or responsibilities could be adjusted.
- **Delegated:** Someone else could appropriately share or undertake it.
- **Discontinued:** It no longer serves a necessary or meaningful purpose.

The commitment I want to review is:

.....

The adjustment I could make is:

.....

Step 4 - Make One Practical Commitment

Complete the following statement:

“To manage my responsibilities more intentionally, I will...”

.....

.....

Step 5 - Reflect After Seven Days

At the end of the week, consider:

Did my adjustment help reduce competing demands or improve how I allocated my time?

.....

What additional support, communication or changes might I need?

.....

8. KEY TAKEAWAYS

1. Everyone occupies multiple roles that influence how time is allocated.
2. Roles, responsibilities and commitments create different demands on our available time.
3. Competing responsibilities can create genuine time pressure, even when time is managed carefully.
4. Overcommitment may arise when expectations consistently exceed realistic personal capacity.
5. Time Intelligence involves understanding obligations, reviewing commitments and making sustainable choices.

FINAL THOUGHT

“You cannot give every responsibility unlimited time, but you can become more intentional about how you honour what matters most.”

Effective time utilisation is not about doing everything. It is about understanding your responsibilities, recognising your limitations and making thoughtful decisions about where your time and energy are needed.

Next Subtopic: Establishing Your Baseline Through the Time Intelligence Diagnostic.

7: Establishing Your Baseline Through the Time Intelligence Diagnostic

- Understanding Your Time Intelligence Baseline
- What Is the Time Intelligence Diagnostic?
- Why Establishing a Baseline Matters
- Understanding Your Diagnostic Results
- Turning Diagnostic Results into Meaningful Action
- Personal Reflection
- Practical Exercise - Your Personal Time Intelligence Baseline

Central Question:

How effectively am I currently using my time, and what do I need to improve?

1. Understanding Your Time Intelligence Baseline

Before making meaningful improvements, it is important to understand your current starting point.

A **baseline** is an initial assessment of your existing behaviours, habits and capabilities before you begin making deliberate changes.

In the context of Time Intelligence, your baseline helps you understand how you currently manage priorities, commitments, attention, personal capacity and execution.

For example, you may believe that procrastination is your biggest challenge, but further reflection could reveal that unclear priorities, excessive commitments or frequent distractions are contributing to the problem.

Establishing a baseline allows you to move beyond assumptions and identify areas that require attention.

Time Intelligence begins with awareness, but meaningful improvement requires understanding what needs to change.

2. What Is the Time Intelligence Diagnostic?

The **Time Intelligence Diagnostic** is a structured self-assessment designed to help participants evaluate their current time-related behaviours across six dimensions.

It provides an opportunity to reflect on existing strengths, recognise areas for improvement and establish a starting point for personal development.

Dimension	What It Measures	Key Question
1. Time Awareness	Understanding how time is currently used.	Do I know where my time goes?
2. Priority Intelligence	Ability to identify and focus on meaningful priorities.	Am I giving time to what matters most?
3. Capacity Intelligence	Ability to manage commitments, energy and available capacity.	Am I taking on more than I can realistically manage?
4. Focus Intelligence	Ability to manage distractions and protect attention.	Can I concentrate on important activities?
5. Execution Intelligence	Ability to overcome delays and complete important tasks.	Do I consistently turn intentions into action?

6. Time Architecture	Ability to establish sustainable routines and systems.	Do I have a reliable structure for managing my time?

These dimensions are interconnected.

For example, poor priority management can affect focus, while excessive commitments can reduce execution capacity.

Understanding the connections helps participants develop a more complete picture of their relationship with time.

3. Why Establishing a Baseline Matters

A baseline serves four important purposes.

1. It Creates Self-Awareness

You gain a clearer understanding of your existing habits, strengths and challenges.

2. It Identifies Development Priorities

Rather than attempting to improve everything simultaneously, you can identify the areas requiring the greatest attention.

3. It Supports Personalised Learning

Your diagnostic results can guide how you apply the tools and exercises introduced throughout the masterclass.

4. It Makes Progress Visible

By completing the same diagnostic at the end of the programme, you can compare your initial responses with your final responses.

The diagnostic is not an examination or a measure of intelligence. It is a developmental reflection tool.

The purpose is not to achieve a perfect score. It is to develop a clearer understanding of your current position and identify opportunities for improvement.

4. Understanding Your Diagnostic Results

The diagnostic consists of **24 statements**, with four statements covering each of the six Time Intelligence dimensions.

Participants rate each statement using a five-point scale.

Rating	Meaning
1	Strongly Disagree
2	Disagree
3	Neither Agree nor Disagree
4	Agree
5	Strongly Agree

For example:

"I have a clear understanding of how I spend my time during a typical week."

A participant who strongly disagrees would select 1, while someone who strongly agrees would select 5.

Each dimension receives a score based on its four statements.

Dimension Score: 4–20 points
Overall Time Intelligence Score: 24–120 points

Higher scores indicate more positive self-reported behaviours across the assessed dimensions, assuming all statements are positively worded.

These scores are intended for personal development and comparison over time. They should not be interpreted as scientifically validated measures of ability or used to rank participants.

5. Turning Diagnostic Results into Meaningful Action

Completing a diagnostic is only valuable when the results inform practical improvement.

After reviewing your results, consider three questions.

What am I already doing well?

Recognise the behaviours and practices that currently support effective time utilisation.

Where am I experiencing the greatest difficulty?

Identify the dimensions that may be limiting your progress.

What one improvement could make the greatest difference?

Select a realistic action that can be implemented during the masterclass.

For example, someone who identifies Focus Intelligence as a development priority may begin by reducing avoidable digital interruptions.

Another participant who identifies Capacity Intelligence as a challenge may need to review existing commitments and establish more realistic expectations.

Your baseline should guide your development, not define your limitations.

6. PERSONAL REFLECTION

Take approximately five minutes to consider the following questions.

Reflection Question 1

Before completing the diagnostic, which of the six Time Intelligence dimensions do you believe is your greatest strength?

Why?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 2

Which dimension do you believe currently presents your greatest challenge?

How does this affect your everyday life?

.....

.....

Reflection Question 3

If you could achieve one meaningful improvement in how you use your time over the next six weeks, what would it be?

.....

.....

7. PRACTICAL EXERCISE - YOUR PERSONAL TIME INTELLIGENCE BASELINE

Duration: 10–15 minutes, following completion of the official diagnostic

Step 1 - Complete Your Diagnostic

Complete the official **Time Intelligence Diagnostic Questionnaire**, responding honestly to all 24 statements.

Think about your typical behaviour rather than how you would ideally like to behave.

Step 2 - Record Your Results

Transfer your scores into the table below.

Time Intelligence Dimension	My Score (4–20)	My Initial Observation
Time Awareness		
Priority Intelligence		
Capacity Intelligence		
Focus Intelligence		
Execution Intelligence		
Time Architecture		
Overall Score (24–120)		

Step 3 - Identify Your Strengths

Which two dimensions received your highest scores?

Strength 1: .....

Strength 2: .....

What existing habits or behaviours may explain these strengths?

.....

Step 4 - Identify Your Development Priorities

Which two dimensions received your lowest scores?

Development Priority 1: .....

Development Priority 2: .....

What challenges or behaviours may be contributing to these results?

.....

Step 5 - Establish Your Six-Week Development Goal

Complete the following statements.

My most important Time Intelligence development priority is:

.....

The behaviour I want to improve is:

.....

By the end of the six-week masterclass, I want to be able to:

.....

Step 6 - Identify One Measurable Indicator

Choose one simple way to observe your progress.

For example:

- Number of important tasks completed each week.
- Frequency of unnecessary interruptions.
- Time spent on meaningful personal priorities.
- Number of commitments reviewed or renegotiated.
- Consistency in following a planned weekly routine.

My progress indicator:

.....

My starting position:

.....

My desired improvement:

.....

Step 7 - Preserve Your Baseline

Keep a copy of your diagnostic results and personal reflections.

At the end of Week 6, you will complete the diagnostic again and compare your responses.

This will help you evaluate changes in your self-reported behaviours, identify areas of improvement and determine where further development is needed.

8. KEY TAKEAWAYS

1. A baseline provides a starting point for understanding current time-related behaviours.
2. The Time Intelligence Diagnostic assesses six interconnected dimensions of personal time utilisation.
3. Diagnostic results help identify existing strengths and development priorities.
4. Honest self-assessment is more valuable than attempting to achieve a high score.
5. Comparing initial and final results can help participants reflect on changes made throughout the masterclass.
6. Meaningful improvement requires translating diagnostic insights into practical action.

FINAL THOUGHT

“You cannot meaningfully improve what you have not taken the time to understand.”

Your Time Intelligence baseline is not a judgement of how well you manage your life. It is a starting point for becoming more intentional about how you use your time, energy and attention.

CLOSING REFLECTION

What Have You Discovered About Your Time?

Throughout Week 1, you have explored your relationship with time, examined your 168-hour week, distinguished busyness from effectiveness, identified time leaks, reviewed your daily habits and considered the responsibilities influencing your time allocation.

You have also established your personal Time Intelligence baseline.

Before moving into Week 2, take a moment to reflect.

1. My biggest discovery about how I currently use my time is:

.....

.....

2. One behaviour or commitment I need to reconsider is:

.....

.....

3. One positive change I will begin making immediately is:

.....

.....

YOUR WEEK 1 PERSONAL COMMITMENT

"From this point forward, I will become more intentional about my time by..."

.....

.....

LOOKING AHEAD - WEEK 2

PRIORITY INTELLIGENCE

Deciding What Truly Deserves Your Time

Central Question: What genuinely deserves my time?

In Week 2, we will move from understanding how time is currently used to making more deliberate decisions about where it should be invested.

Empowering Talent. Transforming Futures.